Form **14446**
(November 2023)

Department of the Treasury - Internal Revenue Service

Virtual VITA/TCE Taxpayer Consent

This form is required when either the Intake/Interview and/or the Quality Review are not conducted in-person between the taxpayer and the VITA/TCE volunteer. The site must explain to the taxpayer the process used to prepare the taxpayer's return. If applicable, volunteers must advise the taxpayer of the associated risk of transferring their data from one site location to another site.

Part I - To be completed by the VITA/TCE site:

Site name

PCDC (Philadelphia Chinatown Development Corporation)

Site address (street, city, state, zip code)

Service address: Crane Center 2nd Floor, 1001 Vine Street, Philadelphia, PA 19107
Main Office: 301-305 N. 9th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19107

Site identification number (SIDN)	Site coordinator name
S25010157	Ping Lee
Site contact name	**Site contact telephone number**
Ping Lee	215-922-6156

This site is using the following Virtual VITA/TCE method(s) to prepare tax returns:

☐ **A. Drop Off Site:** This site uses a drop off process which includes the site maintaining personally identifiable information (Social Security numbers, Form W-2, etc.) to prepare the tax return at the same site but at a later time. In this process, the taxpayer comes back to the same site for the quality review and/or signing the completed tax return. The site must explain the method it uses to contact the taxpayer if additional information is needed.

Note: Sites where the taxpayer does not leave the site's property, for example waiting in another room or in a vehicle, are NOT considered drop off sites. Since the taxpayer remains at the site, they are not required to complete Form 14446. If the taxpayer leaves their tax documents at the site and then leaves the site's property for any reason, the taxpayer must complete Form 14446.

☐ **B. Intake Site:** This method includes the taxpayer leaving their personally identifiable information (Social Security numbers, Form W-2 and other documents) at the site in order to prepare and/or quality review the tax return at another location. In this process, the taxpayer's tax return information may be sent to another location for one or more of the following reasons; interviewing the taxpayer, preparing the tax return, or performing a quality review. The taxpayer may come back to the intake site for the quality review or to review and sign the completed tax return.

☐ **C. Return Preparation and/or Quality Review Only Site:** This site may receive returns from one or more intake sites to prepare and/or quality review returns. This site generally does not take walk-ins or appointments in their location.

☒ **D. Combination Site:** This site prepares returns for other permanent or temporary intake sites and assists walk-ins and appointments in their location.

☐ **E. 100% Virtual VITA/TCE Process**: There is no in-person interaction with the taxpayer and any of the VITA/TCE volunteers in this process, during the intake, interview, return preparation, quality review, and signing the tax return. The site must explain the virtual processes and consent. This includes the virtual procedures to send required documents (Social Security numbers, Form W-2 and other documents) through a secured file sharing system to a designated volunteer for review.

Part II: The Site's Process:

Explain how each process will be followed to assist the taxpayer remotely. The questions in parentheses below provide guidance on what to include in the explanation for each process. How will the site manage:

1. Scheduling the appointment (How is the appointment made: by phone, online portal, email, or by other means)

No appointment is scheduled. All are walk-ins.

2. Securing Taxpayer Consent Agreement (How is the 14446 signed, received, and stored)

Taxpayers will be required to review, signed and submit Form 14446 Virtual VITA Taxpayer Consent before the Site Coordinators assign volunteer preparer to proceed.

3. Performing the Intake Process - securing all documents (How are the taxpayer's supporting documents received, stored and tracked)

Taxpayers are required to complete and submit Form 13614-C Intake/Interview & Quality Review Sheet along with all necessary supporting documents, including photo identification, Social Security cards or ITIN documentation, tax forms such as W-2s and 1099s, and any proof of deductions. For in-person service, taxpayers submit these documents at the site before the Site Coordinator

4. Validating taxpayer's authentication - reviewing photo identification and Social Security cards/ITIN letters (What communication channel, either in-person or virtually, is used to validate the taxpayer's identity and which documents are reviewed)

A copy of the Photo ID(s) for taxpayer and spouse (if applicable) and Social Security Card(s)/ITIN(s) must be on file to begin the process. Identity must be verified at the time of drop off or scheduled zoom video conferening with the taxpayer and spouse (if applicable) before a certified volunteer can proceed interview or preparing the return.

5. Performing the interview with the taxpayer (What communication channel, either in-person or virtually, is used to conduct the interview)

During an interview over a call or Zoom conferencing, the certified preparer will review the completed Form 13614-C intake/interview & Quality Review sheet with the taxpayer, and verify all of the information provided to ensure an accurate tax return.

6. Preparing the tax return (Where is the tax return prepared and how are documents accessed by the preparer)

After the interview, the certified preparer prepares the return without the taxpayer(s) presence. When a clarification is needed, preparer then contacts the taxpayer.

7. Communicating with the taxpayer (Site must explain the method(s) it uses to contact the taxpayer if additional information is needed)

Our site communicates with taxpayers using multiple methods if additional information is needed. We may contact taxpayers by phone call, text message, or email to request details or documentation. Taxpayers also have the option to visit our office during posted business hours to drop off any required information in person. Sometimes, we use a combination of all these methods to ensure timely and accurate communication.

8. Performing the quality review (Where is the tax return reviewed and how are documents accessed by the reviewer)

Return can be shared either through zoom share screen feature or in person, after taxpayer(s) identity is verified.

9. Sharing the completed return (What communication channel, in-person or virtually, is used to share the completed return and how does the volunteer and/or taxpayer access the completed return)

Form 8879, IRS e-file Signature Authorization must be signed by taxpayer and spouse (if applicable), before the completed return can be given to the taxpayer(s). Form can be e-signed or sign in person at the site. A unique link is sent to taxpayer and spouse (if applicable) if e-sign option is chosen.

10. Signing the return (Does taxpayer sign the return in-person or electronically and if electronically, which software is used to sign the return)

Form 8879, IRS e-file Signature Authorization must be signed by taxpayer and spouse (if applicable), before the completed return can be given to the taxpayer(s). Form can be e-signed or sign in person at the site. A unique link is sent to taxpayer and spouse (if applicable) if e-sign option is chosen. We use AdobeSign for electonic signatures.

11. E-filing the tax return (When is the return e-filed: immediately or at the end of the day)

The site coordinators will e-file the tax return the next day, not more than 3 business days after the signed Form 8879 , IRS e-file Signature Authorization is returned.

Page three of this form will be maintained at the site with all other required documents.

Part III: Taxpayer Consents:

Request to Review your Tax Return for Accuracy:

To ensure you are receiving quality services and an accurately prepared tax return at the volunteer site, IRS employees randomly select free tax preparation sites for review. If errors are identified, the site will make the necessary corrections. IRS does not keep any personal information from your reviewed tax return and this allows them to rate our VITA/TCE return preparation programs for accurately prepared tax returns. If you do not wish to have your return included as part of the review process, it will not affect the services provided to you at this site. If the site preparing this return is selected, do you consent to having your return reviewed for accuracy, by an IRS employee?

☒ Yes ☐ No

Virtual Consent Disclosure:

If you agree to have your tax return prepared and your tax documents handled in the above manner, your signature and/or agreement is required on this document. Signing this document means that you are agreeing to the procedures stated above for preparing a tax return for you. (If this is a Married Filing Joint return both spouses must sign and date this document.) If you chose not to sign this form, we may not be able to prepare your tax return using this process. Since we are preparing your tax return virtually, we have to secure your consent agreeing to this process. If you consent to use these non-IRS virtual systems to disclose or use your tax return information, Federal law may not protect your tax return information from further use or distribution in the event these systems are hacked or breached without our knowledge. If you agree to the disclosure of your tax return information, your consent is valid for the amount of time that you specify. If you do not specify the duration of your consent, your consent is valid for one year from the date of signature. If you believe your tax return information has been disclosed or used improperly in a manner unauthorized by law or without your permission, you may contact the Treasury Inspector General for Tax Administration (TIGTA) by telephone at 1-800-366-4484, or by e-mail at complaints@tigta.treas.gov. While the IRS is responsible for providing oversight requirements to Volunteer Income Tax Assistance (VITA) and Tax Counseling for the Elderly (TCE) programs, these sites are operated by IRS sponsored partners who manage IRS site operations requirements and volunteer ethical standards. In addition, the locations of these sites may not be in or on federal property.

I agree to use this site's Virtual VITA/TCE Process		☒ Yes ☐ No	
Printed name		Printed name (spouse if married filing joint)	
Date of birth	Date	Date of birth	Date
Telephone number		Telephone number	
Email address		Email address	
Signature (electronic) **OR**		Signature (electronic) **OR**	
Signature (type/print)		Signature (type/print)	